Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

UPI fraud is a common cybercrime where attackers trick users into transferring money or sharing sensitive details. This type of fraud usually happens through fake calls, messages, or payment requests.

In a typical scenario, a fraudster contacts the victim pretending to be a bank official, delivery agent, or customer. First, they build trust by giving believable information. Next, they send a “collect request” on a UPI app or ask the victim to scan a QR code. The victim is told that entering their UPI PIN will help receive money, which is false. Once the victim enters the PIN, money is actually debited from their account. Sometimes, fake links or apps are also used to steal login details.

The most common targets are students, elderly people, and those who are new to digital payments. People who are unaware of how UPI works are especially vulnerable.

The consequences can be serious. Victims may lose large amounts of money within minutes. Recovery is difficult, and it causes stress, fear, and loss of trust in online systems.

This case highlights the importance of awareness. Users should never share their UPI PIN, avoid unknown links, and always verify requests. Cyber safety education is essential to prevent such frauds in the future.